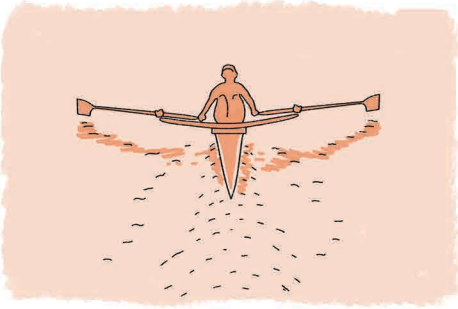
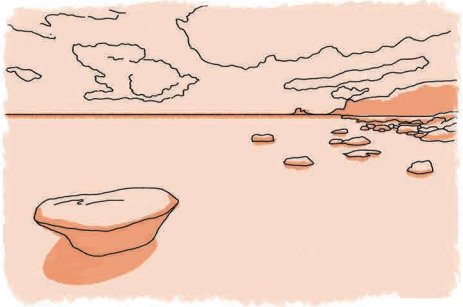
BALANCE

Balance appears in every photograph we capture, weighing the visual weight on one side of the photo against the other. A balanced photo will feel pleasing and harmonious, whereas an unbalanced photo will feel uncomfortable and unresolved. One is not necessarily better than the other, it all depends on the feeling you're trying to evoke with your composition.



Symmetrical

Symmetry is an example of perfect balance in a photograph, where each side of the image has the same visual weight. It's hard to find symmetry in nature, which can make it quite powerful when used well.



Asymmetrical

Also known as informal balance, it is the most common compositional technique, taught in photography and art workshops. It requires intentionally placing your subject off center.

Negative Space

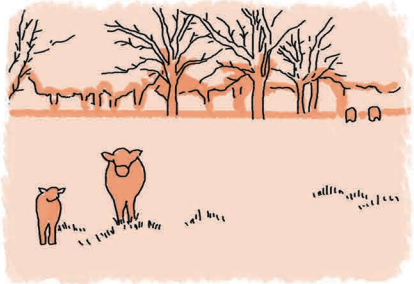
Negative space defines and emphasizes the main subject of a photo, drawing your eye to it. It provides "breathing room", giving your eyes somewhere to rest and preventing your image from appearing too cluttered with "stuff".

VISUAL WEIGHT

When looking at a photograph, our eyes are naturally drawn to look at the area with the most **visual weight** first.

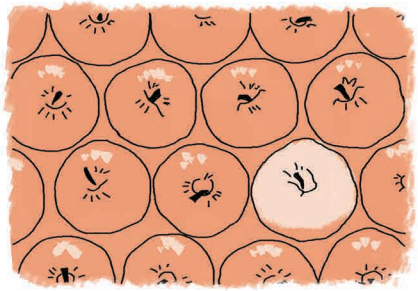
When you understand what this is, you can better influence how people look at your photos.

Size



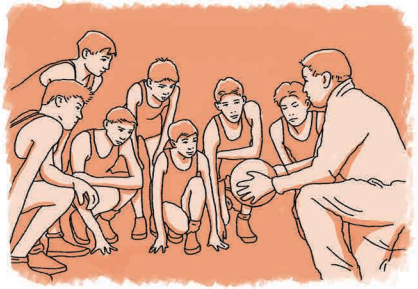
Your eyes will go towards a larger object before a smaller one. It appears more important because it takes up more space.

Contrast



Our eyes are drawn to contrast, such as objects that are brighter or darker than the rest of the scene.

Faces and Eyes



Our brains are wired to look at faces and eyes first. It's a trait that helps us feel the mood of people we encounter.

Placement

Subjects placed away from the centre carry more weight. To counterbalance, have something on the opposite side.

Text

Text in scenes gives us meaning. It can either contrast or complement the environment in which it appears.